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J&T Express - H

2Q26 update: Macro volatility no barrier to scale, quality, and accelerating global growth

J&T's 2Q26 operational update held today (8 July) marks a clear transition from 'build-out + losses' to 'scale, productivity, and capital return'. J&T Express's robust operational trends in the past one quarter, despite the macro headwinds, reinforce our positive stock view and [initiation thesis](#) that J&T's platform-neutral, exportable operating model is scaling outside China. The group delivered 9.18B parcels (+24.2% Y/Y), with daily average volume surpassing 100MM for the first time – a milestone that underpins the company's ability to drive further cost deflation and service consistency. Notably, ex-China parcels accounted for 32.3% of the total, highlighting the growing breadth of J&T's global platform. The company's new HK\$2B buyback plan, at current share price levels, equates to a c.2.4% buyback yield, providing a tangible technical floor for the stock as fundamentals inflect. Management reiterated that March guidance remains unchanged, signaling confidence in the durability of the volume and margin trends, despite ongoing macro and sector volatility.

Stock view: The share price is up c.14% over the past week (vs HSI up c6%) in anticipation of the strong quarterly print (with the date for today's operational update first released on 1 July), so today's muted response post our initiation is not a surprise – especially given the day's AI-driven rotations into HK's index-heavy names such as Alibaba amid fund rebalancing. YTD, the stock remains down 9% but is modestly ahead of HSCI (down 12%) on a relative basis. We stay fundamentally bullish: today's datapoints and briefing takeaways reinforce the re-rating case, with scale, cost/automation proof, and capital return all tracking ahead of plan. The next catalyst is whether these operating trends translate into earnings upgrades at the interim results, in our view. Maintain OW.

- **A new volume milestone and mix shift outside China are strengthening the case for sustainable scale and margin leverage.** J&T's 2Q26 group parcels reached 9.18B (+24.2% Y/Y), with daily average volume exceeding 100MM for the first time. This level of throughput is critical for driving sustained unit-cost deflation and service reliability, as it maximizes network utilization and accelerates automation payback. Ex-China parcels now account for 32.3% of the total, supporting the view that J&T is steadily de-risking from a China-only profit pool and building a more diversified global growth base. We believe management's decision to keep guidance unchanged, despite strong volume prints and macro noise, signals confidence in the underlying momentum and the company's ability to convert scale into durable margin and cash flow.

Overweight

1519.HK, 1519 HK

Price: HK\$9.53

08 Jul 2026

Price Target: HK\$13.00

PT End Date: 30 Jun 2027

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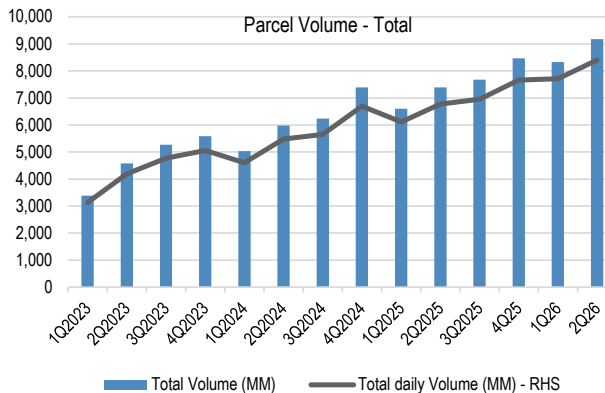
- **Southeast Asia remains the core engine, with growth increasingly driven by platform investment and rising logistics standards rather than just pricing.** SEA parcels reached 2.75B in 2Q26 (+63.2% Y/Y), with daily average volume of 30.3MM. Management attributes this momentum to continued e-commerce penetration, sustained platform client investment in promotions and free shipping, and a deliberate push into non-platform parcels as product, service quality, and brand visibility improve. Importantly, platforms are raising their requirements for logistics partners, which is shifting competition towards scaled operators that can deliver on cost, coverage and reliability. We believe this dynamic supports J&T's positioning as a platform-neutral consolidator with a structural cost and network advantage, and helps mitigate the risk of yield erosion as delivery speeds converge across the industry.
- **China is acting as a stabilizer with upside, with share gains driven by network quality and customer mix rather than aggressive pricing.** China parcels reached 6.21B in 2Q26 (+10.6% Y/Y), with daily average volume of 68.2MM. Management benchmarked industry growth at c.5% Y/Y for Jan-May 2026, positioning J&T as a share gainer through network upgrades, improved service quality, cost control, and technology enablement. The sector is shifting from pure growth to a focus on scale, quality, and efficiency, and J&T is seeing rising recognition from branded and higher-quality customers. The key for investors is whether these share gains can be sustained without sacrificing unit economics, especially as the competitive environment remains structurally intense.
- **Other Markets is now a credible incremental engine, with LATAM leading and five consecutive quarters of acceleration.** Other Markets parcels reached 210MM in 2Q26 (+136.5% Y/Y), marking the fifth straight quarter of acceleration. Management highlighted LATAM as the strongest contributor, while Middle East growth was constrained by conflict. The TAM argument is compelling: higher GDP/capita and consumption, but structurally lower e-commerce penetration and parcels per capita vs China/SEA, provide a long runway for growth if execution holds. J&T is exporting its China/SEA playbook – automation, route optimization, last-mile efficiency – and deepening partnerships with Mercado Libre and Chinese platforms. New market entries (Colombia launched in 2Q, Peru and Central America under evaluation) and a preference for asset-light, compliant entry in the US and Europe further support the long-term growth story.
- **Buybacks, automation, and capex discipline are now central to the equity story, bridging fast growth to compounding quality.** Management provided quantifiable automation outcomes, such as the Tangerang (Indonesia) project reducing processing time by 40% and boosting peak sorting efficiency by 150%. The company reiterated full-year capex guidance of US\$700-800MM, with investment priority across China, SEA, and Other Markets, and incremental focus on LATAM. The new HK\$2B buyback plan, at the current share price and share count, equates to a c.2.4% buyback yield – now a meaningful support for sentiment as the market increasingly demands tangible capital return alongside operational momentum.

Table 1: Global Logistics Comp Table

BBG Ticker	JPM rating	Last Price	JPM PT	Upside/Downside	Mkt Cap US\$Mn	YTD Stock perf.	P/E (x)		EPS Grpwth		PEG	EVEBITDA		ROE (%)		P/B (x)	
							FY26E	FY27E	FY26E	FY27E		FY26E	FY27E	FY26E	FY27E	FY26E	FY27E
SF Holding - A	002352 CH	OW	32.83	42.0	28%	25,027	13.9	12.6	22%	10%	0.6	6.1	5.7	11.5	11.4	1.5	1.4
SF Holding - H	6936 HK	OW	31.54	40.0	27%	25,027	11.3	10.3	10%	10%	1.1	4.9	4.4	11.5	11.4	1.2	1.1
ZTO Express - US	ZTO US	OW	23.17	29.0	25%	17,839	11.8	10.5	12%	13%	0.9	6.7	6.3	15.0	15.4	1.7	1.6
ZTO Express - H	2057 HK	OW	183.10	225.0	23%	17,995	11.9	10.5	19%	13%	0.6	6.8	6.3	15.0	15.4	1.7	1.6
JD Logistics	2618 HK	OW	12.44	20.0	61%	10,591	9.8	8.5	22%	15%	0.5	3.2	3.1	16.3	16.7	1.1	0.9
YTO Express	600233 CH	NC	17.08	NA	NA	8,597	9.7	8.6	42%	13%	0.2	5.5	4.9	15.6	15.7	1.5	1.3
YUNDA Holding	002120 CH	NC	6.82	NA	NA	2,912	10.0	8.9	43%	12%	0.2	4.0	3.7	8.8	9.3	0.9	0.8
STO Express	002468 CH	NC	16.76	NA	NA	3,773	12.4	10.8	55%	15%	0.2	6.5	5.8	16.9	16.5	2.0	1.7
Sinotrans	601598 CH	NC	5.46	NA	NA	5,187	11.7	11.0	-8%	7%	-1.6	7.1	6.6	7.9	8.8	0.9	0.9
CST International	603128 CH	NC	5.28	NA	NA	1,016	15.4	13.3	5%	16%	3.1	11.3	10.2	7.2	8.4	1.1	1.1
J&T	1519 HK	OW	9.58	13.0	36%	11,841	15.3	10.2	106%	48%	0.1	8.6	6.8	18.2	20.9	NA	NA
YMM	YMM US	OW	8.35	10.0	20%	8,663	11.3	9.7	20%	16%	0.6	7.9	6.9	11.8	12.2	1.3	1.1
Average						-1%	12.1	10.4	29%	16%	0.6	6.5	5.9	13.0	13.5	1.4	1.2
Fedex	FDX US	OW	312.88	370.4	18%	74,655	15.8	15.0	10%	5%	1.5	9.6	9.5	15.6	15.2	2.4	2.2
UPS	UPS US	N	111.96	118.0	5%	95,167	15.8	14.1	3%	12%	5.0	9.5	8.9	36.8	41.3	5.9	5.5
DHL	DHL GR	OW	56.40	60.0	6%	74,012	16.8	15.3	9%	10%	1.9	7.6	7.2	16.5	17.5	2.7	2.6
Kuehne + Nagel	KNIN SW	UW	206.40	175.0	15%	30,816	22.9	26.5	20%	-14%	1.1	11.3	11.9	47.3	38.2	10.4	9.8
Expeditors	EXPD US	UW	165.74	139.0	16%	21,677	23.8	23.2	17%	3%	1.4	17.0	17.7	44.2	60.3	12.4	17.9
C.H. Robinson	CHRW US	OW	190.95	196.0	3%	22,504	31.0	24.3	22%	28%	1.4	22.7	18.5	40.3	54.3	12.6	14.4
SAIA	SAIA US	OW	416.00	490.0	18%	11,095	34.7	27.2	31%	28%	1.1	16.2	13.6	13.1	15.6	4.6	3.9
Nippon Express	9147 JP	N	5,479	5,700	4%	8,199	16.4	14.3	24%	15%	0.7	6.4	5.8	1.4	11.4	1.6	1.5
KLN	636 HK	NC	5.79	NA	NA	1,334	7.5	7.2	3%	5%	2.2	4.0	3.9	7.4	7.4	0.6	0.5
CJ Logistics	000120 KS	N	74,500	100,000	34%	1,123	5.9	5.4	3%	10%	2.0	4.6	4.3	5.9	6.1	0.3	0.5
Average						17%	20.7	18.7	14%	10%	1.9	10.9	10.1	20.9	24.4	4.9	5.4

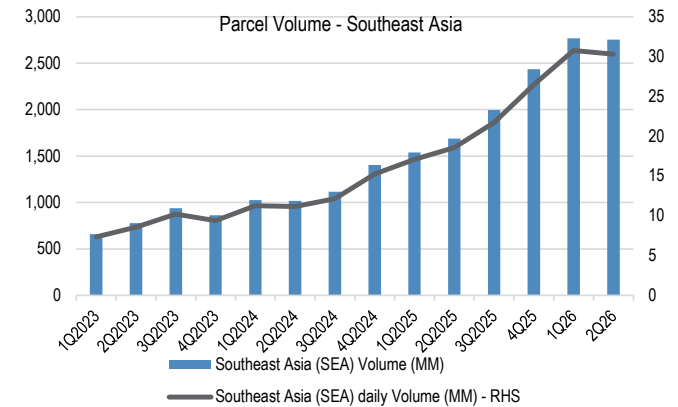
Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. Latest data as of 8 Jul 2026. J.P. Morgan estimates. Note: Estimates for NC stocks are from Bloomberg Finance L.P. Past performance is not an indicator of future results

Figure 1: J&T Parcel Volume Group



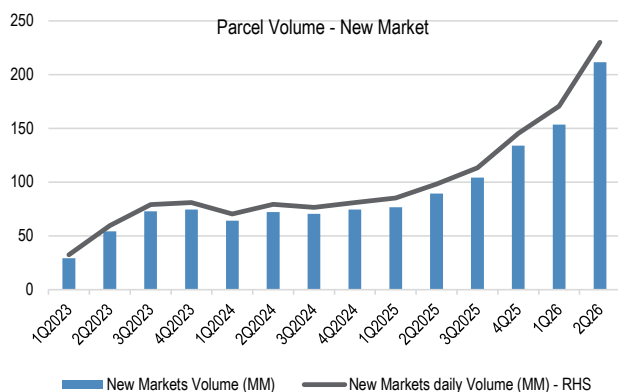
Source: J&T company data, 2Q26 Report Deck as of Jul 8, 2026

Figure 2: J&T Parcel Volume – Southeast Asia



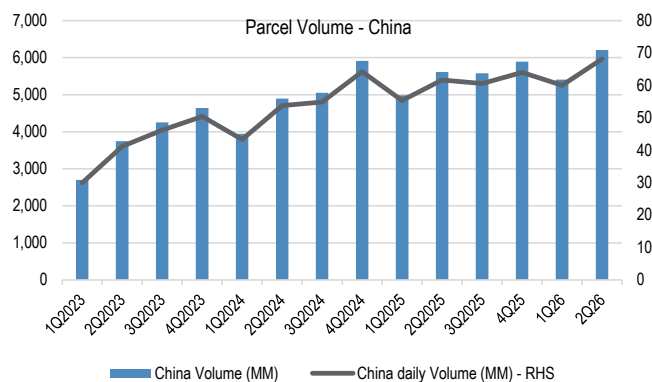
Source: J&T company data, 2Q26 Report Deck as of Jul 8, 2026

Figure 3: J&T Parcel Volume – New Market



Source: J&T company data, 2Q26 Report Deck as of Jul 8, 2026

Figure 4: J&T Parcel Volume – China



Source: J&T company data, 2Q26 Report Deck as of Jul 8, 2026.

Investment Thesis

J&T Global Express is a leading platform-neutral, technology-driven 3PL operator – the market leader in Southeast Asia, a growing player in China, and an emerging challenger in high-growth New Markets (Brazil, Mexico, Middle East). The company's regional sponsor model combines entrepreneurial local execution with centralized technology, enabling rapid, capital-light expansion, while China-built automation and digital management systems are exported across regions, underpinning a structurally advantaged cost curve. Since its October 2023 IPO, J&T's share price has underperformed, reflecting sector price wars in China, initial loss-making status, and external shocks such as recent fuel price volatility. The market has also questioned the scalability of J&T's model outside China and the sustainability of margins in a maturing Southeast Asia, while New Markets were seen as too early-stage to move the needle. However, the business has now pivoted to profitability, is delivering industry-leading volume and margin growth, and is unlocking new synergies through its partnership with SF Holdings. Overweight on J&T.

Valuation

Our Jun-27 P/E-based PT of HK\$13.0 is based on J&T's FY27 Non-IFRS EPS of US\$0.12, 13x target P/E (vs industry average of 11x, Bloomberg estimates, as of Jul 7, 2026) and USD/HKD conversion rate of 7.8.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Downside risks to our rating and price target include: 1) continued structural margin compression in China, if anti-involution weakens; 2) slowdown of SEA ecommerce GMV growth and increasing competition from competitors like SPX etc; 3) execution and profitability slippage in New Markets as heavy upfront investment and slower-than-expected localization of franchise models prolong the path to scale; and 4) geopolitical, regulatory, and trade-policy shocks could increase compliance costs and directly pressure cross-border parcel flows and demand.

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J&T Express - H (1519.HK, 1519 HK) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (HK\$)	Price Target (HK\$)
08-Jul-26	OW	9.47	13

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Jul 07, 2026. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

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